

Blue tea set
1850–99

Part of a set of two, this porcelain bowl with lid and saucer is decorated with famille rose enamel colors on a blue background.



interior is lined with silver

**Brass wedding bowl**
18th century

This brass wedding bowl is part of a set of two. This one is lined with silver—the other has a gilt silver interior—and the base has an engraved design.

panels depict the seasons

**Portable set of eating implements**
1736–95

The contents of this traveling set of eating implements include two pairs of chopsticks, a knife, a pair of forks, and an ivory pick.

Sancai teapot
1662–1772

This teapot is sancai porcelain and has a rectangular shape, with raised panels on each side illustrating the four seasons.

Pewter tea caddy
18th century

This tea caddy is constructed from pewter. Its simple design is embellished with floral and calligraphic engravings.



large bead called Buddha head separates smaller beads

subsidiary string of beads

Ivory necklace for civil servant
1900s

These beads are made of painted ceramic and gold leaf. The larger beads, called Buddha heads, divide up the smaller beads into groups of 27. There are also subsidiary strands of 10 blue beads.

incised inscription

**Xian seal**
19th century

This oval Xian seal has an incised inscription on each of the long sides. The base reads "Living by the Golden Tower."

Golden nail guards
c. 19th century

These elaborate nail guards have gold openwork with a "cracked ice" pattern. The device was designed to protect the nail of the little finger.



peaches symbolize longevity



fine silk

rounded designs popular in 19th century

**Pair of bowed shoes**
1800–1900

These bowed shoes with pointed toes and high heels were worn for outdoor activities by a woman with bound feet. The sides have an intricate embroidered decoration of birds and flowers.

Silk robe
c. 19th century

This woman's black silk robe has a pattern of flowers woven into the fabric. The design also includes a springtime scene involving flowers and butterflies.